

ARTS & ENTERTAINMENT

Assorted Blend

CHENNAI The city will resonate with music, courtesy The Hindu Friday Review November Fest, a nine-day festival at the Music Academy. In its third edition, this event offers the mandatory classical fare, mixed with contemporary Indian as well as modern world music. Kick-starting the festival on November 10 is a bandish recital by Ustad Fateh Ali Khan and Rustam Fateh Ali Khan, the father-son duo from Pakistan.

To add a hint of romance to music, listen to young pianist Anil Srinivasan and Carnatic vocalist Sikkil Gurucharan as they present *Colour of Rain* (on November 11), a concert that integrates Indian and Western classical music. The next day is a concert by the brothers

from the Benaras gharana, Rajan and Sajan Misra. A ghazal bandi by Hariharan and Mandolin Srinivas on November 15 is a must.

For those who get high on fusion, there's Mrigya—a Delhi-based band that blends "Hindustani classical, folk, funk, pop, jazz, Latin and rock"—on November 16. The feather in the festival's cap is a concert by The Forest, a crossover band from Korea that will premier in the city, thanks to the InKo Centre and the Korea Foundation, an affiliate of the Ministry of Trade and Foreign Affairs, Republic of Korea, on November 17.

The grand finale is a performance by prodigious percussionists Trilok Gurtu, Vikku Vinayakram and Selvaganesh with guitarist Prasanna the next day. Concerts begin at 7.15 p.m. Tickets: Rs 100, Rs 300, Rs 500. **by Akhila Krishnamurthy**

IN TANDEM: Vocalists Rajan (right) and Sajan Mishra from the Benares gharana will perform at the festival



art Threadbare Strokes



DIGITAL COLLAGE: Nai works with jute on canvas

MUMBAI His journey with jute began seven years ago when his father's cloth business went kaput. "When my father lost his business, I took a piece of jute and stuck it on a canvas. I was so inspired by the texture that I decided to work with this medium," says artist Manish Nai, who is exhibiting his works at Galerie Mirchandani + Steinruecke. Titled *Minimal Structures*, the collection has 12 jute-on-canvas collages created with layers of tracing paper and jute which give his works a transparent and three-dimensional effect. Nai begins his creations with a computer-generated image and works on it by unravelling threads of jute to create different levels of layers. His palette is subtle with earth tones, beige and black. "What's amazing is how he brings technology and hand craft together. His works have a sculptural effect," explains gallery owner Ranjana Steinruecke. The artist says that most people feel his works are woven but it is the other way round. Nai starts with jute fabric and then removes threads to complete his picture. He elaborates his forms through varying inflections of tone, shape and thickness. "His works have a minimalist look and move away from figuration and narration which is so common these days," says Steinruecke. On till November 30.

by Aditi Pai

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